10-Point POPIA & Data Protection Readiness Checklist

A practical self-check for South African small businesses. Use it to identify gaps to discuss and prioritise—not as a formal compliance assessment.

How to use this checklist
For each item, mark one response: Yes, Partly, No or Not sure. Any “Partly”, “No” or “Not sure” answer is a prompt to investigate and agree a proportionate next step.

Readiness check	Yes	Partly	No	Not sure
1. Personal information inventory Do you know what personal information your business collects, why it is needed, where it is stored and who can access it?	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
2. Privacy information Do customers, staff and other relevant people receive appropriate information about how their personal information is used?	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
3. Access controls Are access rights limited to people who need them, and are old accounts and access permissions reviewed or removed?	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
4. Passwords and multi-factor authentication Are strong, unique passwords and MFA used for important email, cloud, finance and administrator accounts?	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
5. Backups and recovery Are important business data backed up, and have you tested that data can be restored?	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
6. Phishing and staff awareness Do staff know how to recognise suspicious messages and report suspected scams or data exposure?	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
7. Device and software security Are devices protected with supported software, security updates, screen locks and suitable endpoint protection?	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
8. Incident readiness Is there a clear way to report, record, investigate and escalate a suspected security or personal-information incident?	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
9. Retention and secure disposal Do you know how long key records should be kept and how paper records, devices and data are securely disposed of?	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
10. Suppliers and accountability Have you considered the personal information handled by suppliers, your Information Officer arrangements and who is responsible for follow-up?	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]

Your priority actions

Priority gap / risk	Next action	Owner / target date

Want help deciding what to tackle first?

Book a **FREE telephonic discovery call** with Lindeka IT & Cyber Solutions to discuss your priorities and possible next steps.

Website: lindeka.co.za **Email:** info@lindeka.co.za **Phone/WhatsApp:** 082 430 2369

Important: This checklist is an educational readiness self-assessment only. It is not legal advice, a formal audit, certification or a guarantee of POPIA compliance. Requirements depend on your circumstances; obtain suitable professional advice where needed.